TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain What Was Decided to Someone Who Missed the Meeting

Explain | PPF | Information Briefing

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Tell a colleague who missed a meeting what was decided and why, what it means now, what they need to do and by when, and what is still open.

WHO You work in a small company in JB. On Monday morning Kumar, from sales, was with a customer in Kluang, so he missed the weekly team meeting.

SITUATION At the meeting the team decided: from next Monday, every customer message on the sales phone gets a reply within two hours, because 15 customers complained about slow replies last month. It is Wednesday.

NEED Kumar asks what he missed. He and Siti now take turns with the sales phone: he has it on Tuesdays and Thursdays, Siti on the other days. He takes it from Siti at 9 a.m. next Tuesday and must read the new reply list by Friday.

GOAL Tell Kumar what was decided and why, what it means now, what he needs to do and by when, and what is still open: who answers at lunch (1 to 2). Mr. Tan will decide by Friday.

Decided on Monday

- Every customer message on the sales phone: a reply within two hours
- Why: 15 customers complained about slow replies last month
- Starts next Monday

For Kumar

- Sales phone: Kumar on Tuesdays and Thursdays, Siti on Mondays, Wednesdays and Fridays
- Take the phone from Siti: next Tuesday, 9 a.m.
- Read the new reply list (Siti emailed it on Tuesday) by Friday
- Not decided: who answers at lunch, 1 to 2 (Mr. Tan, by Friday)

SLIDE 03

Try it first

Kumar asks: “Hi! I was with a customer in Kluang on Monday, so I missed the team meeting. What did I miss?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04

A good message

Mei Ling’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Kumar, on Monday we decided to reply to every customer message on the sales phone within two hours. We decided this because 15 customers complained last month. So from next Monday, you and Siti take turns with the sales phone: you on Tuesdays and Thursdays, Siti on the other days. For example, next Tuesday is your day. What you need to do: take the phone from Siti at 9 a.m. next Tuesday. Before that, please read the new reply list by Friday. Siti emailed it yesterday. One thing is still open: who answers at lunch, from 1 to 2. Mr. Tan will decide by Friday, and I'll tell you. Is that clear?

P WHAT WAS DECIDED

P WHAT IT MEANS NOW

F WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

! STILL OPEN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali tells Mei Ling what the IT meeting decided. Order: decided → now → you need to → still open.

- [ ] So now the shared drive makes a copy of every file at 11 p.m. every night.
- [ ] Files from last year aren't decided yet. Mr. Tan will tell us next week. Shall I say that again?
- [ ] You need to move your invoice folders from your laptop to the shared drive by next Wednesday.
- [ ] On Thursday we decided to keep all files on the shared drive, because a laptop broke in May and we lost two weeks of work.

Write the letter: **P** = What was decided · **P** = What it means now · **F** = What you need to do · **!** = Still open

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

WHAT WAS DECIDED

- [ ] At the meeting, we decided to …
- [ ] The main decision is that …
- [ ] Mr. Tan agreed to …

WHY

- [ ] We decided this because …
- [ ] The main reason is that …
- [ ] For example, last month …

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

- [ ] So now …
- [ ] From next week, …
- [ ] This means you need to …
- [ ] Please … by …

STILL OPEN

- [ ] One thing isn't decided yet: …
- [ ] … will decide by …
- [ ] I'll tell you by …

CHECK

- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] Any questions about …?

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Fifteen customers complained last month. [so / for example, / because] we decided to reply within two hours.

2. We decided to reply within two hours [so / because / for example,] customers were waiting too long.

3. You and Siti take turns with the sales phone. [For example, / But / Because] next Tuesday is your day.

4. The two-hour rule is decided. [because / but / so] lunch time isn't decided yet.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. At the meeting on Monday, Mr. Tan _____ yes to the new rule. (What the meeting did, with a past time)
   ○ saying ○ said ○ say

2. Last month, 15 customers _____ about slow replies. (The reason: what happened before)
   ○ complaining ○ complained ○ complain

3. Mr. Tan _____ decide about lunch time by Friday. (What someone will do later)
   ○ will to ○ is will ○ will

4. You _____ to read the reply list by Friday. (The listener's job, with a deadline)
   ○ needing ○ need ○ needs

SLIDE 09

Decided → will / need to

Say what the meeting did in the past (decided, agreed). Say what happens next with will or need to, and add a day with by. For what is not decided, use isn't decided yet.

On Monday we **decided** to reply within two hours.

We decided this **because** 15 customers **complained**.

You **need to** read the list **by** Friday.

Lunch time **isn't decided yet**. Mr. Tan **will decide** by Friday.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

WHAT WAS DECIDED

On Monday we decided to … We decided this because …

P

WHAT IT MEANS NOW

So from next Monday, … For example, next …

F

WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

What you need to do: … by …

!

STILL OPEN

One thing is still open: … will decide by … Is that clear?

SLIDE 11

Information Briefing

The listener missed the meeting. The speaker tells what was decided and why, what it means, what the listener must do by when, and what is still open. The listener fills the meeting note.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Speaker: say your card number. The card is mixed up: say decided and why → now → you must → still open.
2. Listener: fill the note. Ask 'What do I need to do, and by when?' A line empty? Ask 'Why?' Read the note back in order.
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move up one seat. Same card to a new listener, shorter. Listeners use the next column.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: speakers turn the workbook over. New listener. Then swap roles, rounds 1–3 again.

Card 1 · The annual dinner

Card 2 · Colour printing

Card 3 · A new way into the office

Card 4 · The company van

Listener's note: the meeting

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Decided, and why			
What it means now			
I must … by when			
Still open			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Kumar asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. Sorry, why did we decide this?
2. When is my first day with the phone?
3. What happens at lunch time?

Start with: **Because last month …** · **Your first day is …** · **That isn't decided yet. Mr. Tan …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Your neighbour missed the residents' meeting at your condo. It was decided: the swimming pool closes from 1 to 15 March, because there is a leak. Every unit pays RM50 for the repairs by 28 February. Not decided yet: the gym may close too; the management will say next week. Explain it to your neighbour.

At the meeting, we decided … · **This is because …** · **So you need to … by …** · **One thing isn't decided yet: …**

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says what was decided, with one reason.
- [ ] Says what the listener needs to do and by when; the listener's note has it right.
- [ ] Says clearly what is not decided yet, and when the listener will hear.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

The decision and why	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
What you need to do, and when	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
What is still open	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The annual dinner

You are Ali. You were on leave on the day of the meeting. Fill in your meeting note. Then ask: 'What do I need to do, and by when?' Read your note back.

Card 2 · Colour printing

You are Mei Ling. You were at the bank during the meeting. Fill in your meeting note. Then ask: 'Why did you decide this?' and 'What do I need to do?'

Card 3 · A new way into the office

You are Siti. You were at a training course during the meeting. Fill in your meeting note. Then ask: 'When does it start?' and 'What do I need to do?'

Card 4 · The company van

You are Kumar. You were at a customer's office in Pasir Gudang during the meeting. Fill in your meeting note. Then ask: 'How much will it cost?' and 'What do I need to do, and by when?'

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The annual dinner

Still open: the date, 6 or 13 December (Mr. Tan chooses on Friday) · Ali: get two sound system prices by next Wednesday · Why: the hotel cost RM9,000 last year · Decided: a seafood restaurant, not a hotel · Now: budget RM5,000

Card 2 · Colour printing

Mei Ling: email Siti a day before colour jobs · Why: ink cost RM800 last month (usually RM400) · Decided: colour only with Siti's OK · Still open: colour invoices? (Mr. Tan decides on Monday) · Now: black and white as before

Card 3 · A new way into the office

Now: old keys stop working on 1 November · Siti: collect a photo from everyone by Friday · Why: two keys went missing in September · Still open: a card for the cleaner? (Mr. Tan will say on Monday) · Decided: staff cards, not keys

Card 4 · The company van

Why: it broke down twice this year · Kumar: get a second price by Wednesday · Decided: a service every 3 months, RM1,200 a year · Still open: which workshop (Mr. Tan chooses on Friday) · Now: no deliveries on service days